

DVD players have a fixed region code that can only be changed a maximum of five times. This region coding is especially used in DVD movies to prevent people from viewing a movie on DVD before it is released in theatres.

For example, say a movie is released on DVD in the US, but has still not even been shown in theatres in India, then without region coding, people would import discs from the US to India and distribute them freely here. This would affect box office sales, and directly hurt the pockets of the movie's producers. There are six regions in total, read on...

DVD Region 1

USA, Canada

DVD Region 2

Greenland, Europe, the Middle East, Egypt, South Africa, Japan

DVD Region 3

Hong Kong, Korea, Taiwan, Philippines, Indonesia

DVD Region 4

South America, Mexico, Australia, New Zealand, Pacific Islands, Caribbean

DVD Region 5

India, Russia, Eastern Europe, Most of Africa, North Korea, Mongolia

DVD Region 6

China

Region Free DVD

In addition to the six regions, there is another symbol you might see on your DVD which symbolises that the DVD does not have region coding, and can be played on a DVD in any zone.